

ID: SOMA-M-T01A-P01

Title: Being (Variation A) with Opening the Senses

Timing Audit:

- **Total Duration:** 11m 59s (**889** words; 192 Intro + 11 Bridge + 686 Practice)
- **Intro + Bridge:** 1m 59s (**203** words; 192 words + 11w Bridge)
- **Practice:** 9m 59s (**686** words)
- **Silence:** 140s total (3 Long, 3 Short, 1 Final)

Readability: Grade 5

Script Content:

[Intro]

Welcome to this practice. Today we will explore the concept of Being.

Life can be demanding, often requiring us to do many things - day in, day out.

Life is busy. We do many things every day. Sometimes, we just go through the motions. We call this "automatic pilot." This means we only pay partial attention to what we are doing.

We are physically present, but the mind is elsewhere. Occupied with thoughts. Often about the past or the future. This is entirely natural!

But we can learn to pause from being on automatic pilot.

You can learn to connect with the present moment, by engaging your senses.

We take a step back, and gently practice what it's like to be accepting of how things are in the present moment.

When we take this pause, we open up to the possibility of not controlling or interfering with what is going on.

This does not mean we have to agree with what is happening, or even like it. It's about being more present to our experience, by being an observer of it.

It's an intentional pause from the never-ending busyness of modern life.

[Bridge] Now, we will move into a short practice to explore this.

[Practice]

When you're ready, let's begin this practice.

Find a position that feels steady and comfortable. You can sit, stand, or lie down. Try to stay awake.

If you are sitting, it may be helpful to have your legs uncrossed, and your feet placed flat on the floor.

If you need to move during this practice, that is fine. You can wiggle your fingers or toes. You can roll your shoulders. Do what feels right for your body.

[Short Pause] (10s - Settling in)

If you like, taking a deeper breath now and softening your gaze on an out-breath, without closing the eyes.

Beginning to pay attention to your surroundings. Slowly, allowing your eyes to receive... different colors, different shapes, different objects...

You might become aware that some objects are larger than others, and some things are positioned nearer or further away from you.

Do not search for anything special. Just gently notice what you see. Perhaps acknowledging a few different things, such as objects, textures, and colours. Noticing, and then moving on to noticing something else that naturally comes into your visual attention.

[Long Pause] (30s - Visual practice)

Now when you're ready, allowing your attention to shift to the sense of touch. Paying attention to any sense of physical contact that comes into your awareness.

Perhaps noticing the physical contact between your body and the ground you're standing on, or the chair you're sitting on. You might bring your attention to where your hands are placed, and the texture of the surface they're resting on.

What about the feel of your feet wrapped in your shoes, the touch of the clothes against your body, or the touch of the air against your skin? You might also become aware of movements in the air, and the temperature of the space you're in.

Taking the next few moments; engaging your sense of touch, and noticing things you're in contact with. Allowing this noticing to arise naturally, and only practicing as much or as little as feels comfortable to you.

[Long Pause] (30s - Tactile practice)

When you're ready, taking a deep breath in, and as you exhale, allowing your eyes to gently close, or lower your gaze to the floor. And shifting your attention to the sense of hearing, allowing the ears to receive sounds around you.

What sounds are present in your environment? You might notice more than one sound at once, and some sounds being louder or softer, nearer to you or further away.

Paying attention to the presence of sounds. Acknowledging some sounds you hear. If you notice the sound of traffic, simply acknowledging that the sound of traffic is here right now. Then, move on to the next sound that arises in your awareness. If it is silent in your immediate environment, noticing what silence may sound like, or being with the absence of sound.

[Long Pause] (30s - Auditory practice)

And now, when you're ready, bringing your attention to your sense of smell, whilst allowing the breath to be natural.

Can you smell anything? Maybe it is a pleasant smell. Maybe it is an unpleasant smell. Or, maybe it is a neutral smell.

If no smell comes up for you, then that too is perfectly valid as your present experience. Simply acknowledging that.

[Short Pause] (10s - Olfactory practice)

And now, when you are ready, bringing your attention, to your sense of taste. Sensing the presence of any taste in your mouth, as it is right now.

You might sense a sweet taste, a sour taste, a bitter taste, or even a neutral one. Here too, there is no need to know what you're tasting at the moment. As always, practicing as much or as little as feels comfortable to you. Being with your sense of taste, for what it is.

[Short Pause] (10s - Gustatory practice)

Now, gently letting go of any specific focus. Allowing your awareness to expand, simply resting here for a moment, and letting yourself be exactly as you are, right now.

And now, we will gently bring this practice to a close. It may be helpful to get a sense of the whole body sitting or standing or lying. Perhaps taking a deeper breath or two if you like, and then opening your eyes if they were closed.

[Pause] (20s - Final integration)

Thank you for your practice

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